

Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act 2015 **Annual Report**

2021 REPORT



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National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons
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NAPTIP Mission Statement

To protect all persons against Human Trafficking and Violence Against Persons through a people centered access to justice, and the provision of safe spaces.

NAPTIP Vision Statement

Towards a nation free from Human Trafficking and Violence Against Persons.

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List of Abbreviations

AEIG	Abiodun Essiet Initiative for Girls
CSO	Civil Society Organisations
CWEENS	Christian Women for Excellence and Empowerment in Nigerian Society.
EFCC	Economic and Financial Crimes Commission
FCT	Federal Capital Territory
FCTSGBVRT	Federal Capital Territory Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team.
FMWA	Federal Ministry of Women Affairs
Hi-MAT	High level Multi Agency Task Team
LACVAW	Legislative Advocacy Coalition for Violence Against Women
NAPTIP	National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons
NBS	National Bureau of Statistics
NCoS	Nigeria Correctional Service
NCWD	National Centre for Women Development
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NHRC	National Human Rights Commission
NIMC	National Identity Management Commission
NPF	Nigeria Police Force
NSCDC	Nigeria Security and Civil Defence Corps
NSOD	Nigeria Sex Offenders Database
PCSOT	Post-Conviction Sex Offender Testing
RoLAC	Rule of Law and Anti-corruption Programme
SARC	Sexual Assault Referral Center
SGBV	Sexual and Gender Based Violence
SPARC	Service Providers Accountability Resource Committee
SPR	Service Provider Register
STI	Sexually Transmitted Infections
VAC	Violence Against Children
VAP	Violence Against Persons
VAPP Act	Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act
WOTCLEF	Women Trafficking and Child Labor Eradication Foundation.



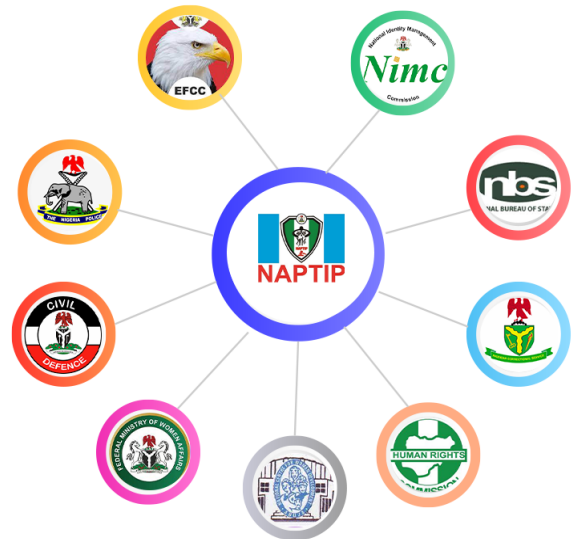
Muhammadu Buhari
President, Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces
Federal Republic of Nigeria



Hajiya Sadiya Umar Farouq (Mrs.)
Honourable Minister,
Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs, Disaster
Management and Social Development

High-Level Multi-Agency Task Team (Hi-MAT)

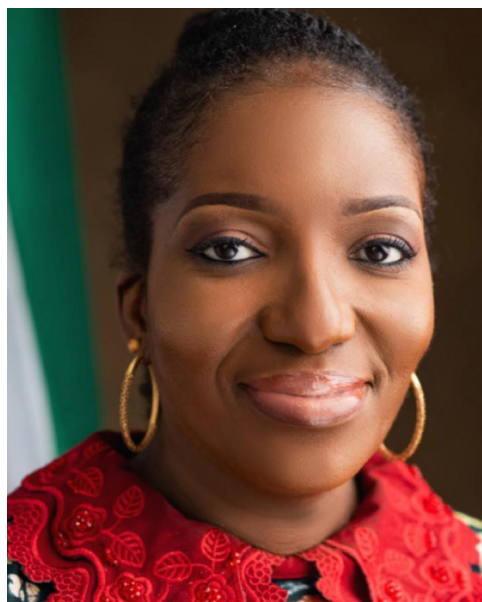
- National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons
- Nigeria Police Force
- Nigeria Security and Civil Defence Corps
- Federal Ministry of Women Affairs
- National Centre for Women Development
- National Human Rights Commission
- Nigeria Correctional Service
- National Bureau of Statistics
- National Identity Management Commission
- Economic and Financial Crimes Commission



Service Providers Accountability Resource Committee



Acknowledgement



Prof. Fatima Waziri-Azi, Ph.D
Director-General
NAPTIP

Our profound gratitude goes to Ford Foundation for providing the resources for the development and printing of the 2nd Edition of the Violence Against Persons Prohibition (VAPP) Annual Implementation Report, 2021.

We commend the Ministry of Women Affairs, Nigerian Police Force (NPF), Economic and Financial Crimes Commission (EFCC), Nigeria Security and Civil Defence Corps (NSCDC), Nigerian Correctional Services (NCoS), National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), National Identity Management Commission (NIMC), National Centre for Women Development (NCWD), National Bureau of Statistics (NBS) and the FCT SGBVRT for their invaluable contributions towards the development of this report.

We particularly appreciate the proactiveness of States for adopting the VAPP Act as Law in their respective States. We are grateful to the Service Providers Accountability Resource Committee (SPARC) for their efforts towards the development of this 2nd Edition VAPP Annual Implementation Report and also for assisting in the implementation of the Act across the Federation.

Finally, I cannot but commend the efforts and commitments of the NAPTIP Team under the coordination of Mrs. Chinenye Edeoga, the VAPP Coordinator for the prevention of domestic violence in the FCT and for the preparation of this report.

We look forward to working with all stakeholders in subsequent annual reports.

Executive Summary



The Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act (VAPP Act) 2015 was necessitated due to agitations for protection of persons against different forms of violence which have in recent times become a recurring decimal in Nigeria. Sexual violence is a worldwide crisis which Nigeria is not exempted from. Over the years, there have been reports made public by individuals, civil society organizations and the media of widespread sexual violence.

Since the enactment of the VAPP Act (2015), States have progressively adopted the Act as law. The National Agency for Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons (NAPTIP) is saddled with the responsibility of combating the crime of Violence Against Persons especially in the Federal Capital Territory (FCT). To prevent and eradicate these crimes, effective and efficient measures must be adopted to strengthen cooperation with the relevant Law Enforcement and Security Agencies, International Organizations and other relevant partners in one hand. In the same token, ensure victims of these offences get adequate access to justice.

This report is in fulfillment of section 42 of the VAPP Act, which mandates NAPTIP to submit an annual report to the Federal Government on implementation of the Act. This report evaluates the progressive implementation of the Act by examining successes, challenges, lessons and highlights recommendations on viable next steps to ensure the Act achieves its objectives of prohibiting violence against persons.

The main thrust of the VAPP Act is to eliminate violence in private and public life, prohibit all forms of violence against persons, provide maximum protection and effective remedies for victims as well as punishment of offenders and for other related matters. In order to reduce violence against persons to its barest minimum, a holistic approach by all the stakeholders entailing integrated actions on policy formulation, prevention, protection and prosecution of offenders is essential.

NAPTIP coordinates the implementation of the provisions of the VAPP Act by setting up strategic structures which are - High level Multi Agency Task Team (Hi-MAT) and Service Providers Accountability Resource Committee (SPARC). The HiMAT membership comprises of 10 government stakeholders that are key in the implementation of the Act. While the SPARC members are The Civil Society Organisations (CSO), Faith Based Organisations, as well as Service Providers. These structures which were set up with the support of the EU Funded Rule of Law and Anti-corruption (ROLAC) implemented by British Council are aimed at building synergy amongst members as well as strengthening seamless relationship in the full implementation of the Act in their different sectors of operation.

This report highlights the mandate and roles of all Hi-MAT, SPARC members and other stakeholders. It examines VAP cases reported, investigated, convictions secured and victims sheltered by stakeholders within the reporting period. The report also highlights the role of the Nigeria Sexual Offenders Database which is a register mandated by VAPP Act to document sexual violence cases with a view of naming and shaming offenders and to provide a veritable tool for the enhanced background checks for certain category of persons.

Furthermore, the report analyzed the trends and challenges encountered during the year under review which are, but not limited to- inadequate amount of shelters and Sexual Assault Referral Centers (SARC) in the FCT, lengthy court processes, culture of silence, amongst others.

The report concludes that strong synergies amongst violence against persons actors remain strategic towards efficient actualization of protection of the rights of citizens so as to build a Nigerian society devoid of violence. Recommendation on how to ameliorate these challenges were also proffered.

Introduction

Context

Before the enactment of the VAPP Act in 2015 by the National Assembly, most States relied on the Criminal and Penal code to enforce the rights of persons who suffer violence, and to punish offenders. Lagos State was the first State in the country to have enacted a prior law similar to the VAPP Act, titled Protection Against Domestic Violence Law, 2007. The enactment of the VAPP Act in 2015 set the stage for states to adopt and pass same as law.¹

For the 2021 implementation of the VAPP Act in the Federal Capital Territory (FCT), NAPTIP and stakeholders have been able to galvanize efforts and record some strides, which include: the appointment of a Coordinator for the prevention of domestic violence², appointment of Protection Officers in each Area Council in the FCT, hosting of High-Level Multi-Agency Task Team (Hi-MAT) meetings, hosting of Service Providers Accountability Resource Committee (SPARC) meetings, liaising with the Judiciary for the swift assignment of cases and designation of Judges to try SGBV cases, establishment of a Sexual Assault Referral Centre (SARC) in the FCT, to mention just a few.

Rationale

The Annual Report on the Implementation of the Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act, 2015 (VAPP Act) is in fulfillment of the obligation created under Section 42 of the VAPP Act 2015 which provides that **“The body vested with the enforcement of this Act shall appoint a person as the Coordinator for the prevention of domestic violence who shall submit annual report to the Federal Government on the Implementation of the Act, a copy of which shall be deposited with the National Bureau for Statistics”**. The Maiden annual report was presented to stakeholders on the 3rd of December 2021. The report being the maiden edition since the VAPP Act was enacted, include reports of activities from 2015 to 2020.

1 As at the time of drafting this report in 2022, thirty- five States now have VAPP Laws.

2 Chinenye Edeoga was appointed in September 2021. She is a Legal Practitioner and an Assistant Director at NAPTIP.

This 2021 report covers activities of Government and Non-Governmental Organizations during the period under review and provides an insight into the level of implementation of the Act by relevant stakeholders, thereby revealing the challenges and limitations.

This report comprises of Five (5) chapters. Chapter one introduces the report and gives an overview of the VAPP Act, methodology of the study, which includes the collation of reports from members of Hi-MAT, SPARC and other stakeholders. The collated data were further structured into five thematic areas of approach in the fight against Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) which are; (Policy, Prevention, Protection, Prosecution, and Partnership). Chapter two and three examines the contributions of organizations, who are either Hi-MAT or SPARC members. Chapter four focuses on the Nigeria Sexual Offenders Database (NSOD) while chapter five discusses the trends, challenges and recommendations.

Overview of the VAPP Act

The Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act is an act to eliminate violence in private and public life, prohibit all forms of violence against persons, provide maximum protection as well as effective remedies for victims and punishment for offenders.

The VAPP Act consists of 6 parts and 318 provisions presented in 51 major sections.

PART 1:

consists of sections 1-26; provides for the definition of rape and other offences, as well as the associated punishment for those offences.

PART 2:

consists of sections 27 – 38; provides for the jurisdiction of the courts and issuance of protection order.

PART 3:

consists of sections 39–43; each section provides for the registration and powers of service providers, protection officers, provides for the appointment of a coordinator for prevention of domestic violence and defines dangerous sexual offenders.

PART 4:

is covered by section 44, which provides for a regulatory body and gives the National Agency for the prohibition Trafficking in Persons and other related matters (NAPTIP) the additional mandate of implementing the provisions of the VAPP Act.

PART 5:

is covered by section 45, which provides for consequential amendment to review obsolete and discriminatory laws by its general savings and repeal.

PART 6:

consists of sections 46 – 48, which provides for the interpretation of terms, application, and citation of the VAPP Act.

The Penalties Under the VAPP Act

The VAPP Act contains 26 offences, and the punishment for each offence range from one year to life imprisonment. These are:

A. RAPE – LIFE IMPRISONMENT
Where offender is less than 14 years -: 14 years imprisonment.
In all other cases -: To a minimum of 12 years imprisonment without an option of fine.

RAPE BY A GROUP OF PERSONS -: Offenders are liable jointly to a minimum of 20 years imprisonment without an option of fine.

B. WILFULLY CAUSING OR INFLICTING PHYSICAL INJURY
Imprisonment for a term of years not exceeding 5 years or a fine not exceeding N100,000.00 or both.

C. ATTEMPT TO COMMIT ACTS OF VIOLENCE
Imprisonment for a term of years not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

D. INCITING, AIDING OR COUNSELLING ANOTHER PERSON TO COMMIT ACTS OF VIOLENCE
Imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

E. RECEIVING OR ASSISTING ANOTHER IN COMMITTING AN OFFENCE OF VIOLENCE
A term of imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

F. COERCING ANOTHER TO ENGAGE IN ACTS DETRIMENTAL TO THE OTHER PERSON'S PHYSICAL OR PSYCHOLOGICAL WELL BEING
3 years imprisonment.

G.

WILFULLY PLACING A PERSON IN FEAR OF PHYSICAL INJURY

2 years imprisonment or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

H.

COMPELLING ANOTHER BY FORCE OR THREAT TO ENGAGE IN ANY CONDUCT OR ACT, SEXUAL OR OTHERWISE TO THE DETRIMENT OF THE VICTIM'S PHYSICAL OR PSYCHOLOGICAL WELL BEING

Imprisonment not exceeding 2 years or a fine not exceeding N500,000.00 or both.

I.

PERFORMANCE OF FEMALE CIRCUMCISION/ GENITAL MUTILATION

A term of imprisonment not exceeding 4 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

J.

FRUSTRATING INVESTIGATION

Imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N500,000.00 or both.

K.

WILFULLY MAKING FALSE STATEMENTS IN ANY JUDICIAL PROCEEDING UNDER THE ACT

A fine of N200,000.00 or a term of imprisonment not exceeding 12 months.

L.

FORCEFUL EJECTION FROM HOME

Imprisonment not exceeding 2 years or a fine not exceeding N300,000.00 or both.

M.

DEPRIVING A PERSON OF HIS/HER LIBERTY

Imprisonment not exceeding 2 years or a fine not exceeding N500,000.00 or both.

N.

DAMAGE TO PROPERTY WITH INTENT TO CAUSE DISTRESS

2 years Imprisonment or a fine not exceeding N300,000.00 or both.

O. FORCED FINANCIAL DEPENDENCE OR ECONOMIC ABUSE
Imprisonment not exceeding 2 years or a fine not exceeding N500,000.00 or both.

P. FORCED ISOLATION OR SEPARATION FROM FAMILY AND FRIENDS
Imprisonment not exceeding 6 months or a fine not exceeding N100,000.00 or both.

Q. EMOTIONAL, VERBAL AND PSYCHOLOGICAL ABUSE
Imprisonment not exceeding 1 year or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

R. HARMFUL WIDOWHOOD PRACTICES
A term of imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

S. ABANDONMENT OF SPOUSE, CHILDREN OR OTHER DEPENDANTS WITHOUT SUSTENANCE
Imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N500,000.00 or both.

T. STALKING
Imprisonment not exceeding 2 years.

U. INTIMIDATION
Imprisonment not exceeding 1 year or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

V. SPOUSAL BATTERY
Imprisonment not exceeding 3 years or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

W. **HARMFUL TRADITIONAL PRACTICES**
2 years imprisonment or a fine not exceeding N200,000.00 or both.

X. **VIOLENCE BY STATE ACTORS**
Imprisonment not exceeding 4 years or a fine not exceeding N1,000,000.00 or both.

Y. **POLITICAL VIOLENCE**
Imprisonment not exceeding 4 years or fine of N500,000.00 or both.

Z. **INCEST**
10 years imprisonment without an option of fine

Operationalisation of the Act

NAPTIP being the body charged with the responsibility of administering the Act is mandated to collaborate with relevant stakeholders and faith-based organisations. In other words, the Act encourages a whole of society approach and seeks to strengthen collaboration amongst key stakeholders, including other Government Agencies. This can be adduced from the multi-functional structure of the Act which essentially confers responsibilities on NAPTIP, the Police, relevant Ministries and Civil society. It is also important to note that only the High Court of the FCT, has the sole jurisdiction to hear and grant any application brought under the Act by virtue of **Section 27 of the Act**.

Methodology

This report was prepared with the concerted efforts of NAPTIP and partners including government, non-governmental organizations and the civil society. The office of the Coordinator for Prevention of Domestic Violence, with support from the Director-General of NAPTIP, developed a template which was adopted by Hi-MAT and SPARC members. All stakeholders captured in this report provided critical data and information based on the template, which was then collated by NAPTIP. The statistics from the template was analyzed by the National Bureau of Statistics (NBS). The analysis from the NBS was forwarded to NAPTIP and formed the basis of this report.

Implementation of Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act 2015 in the Federal Capital Territory

The VAPP Act 2015 stipulates a reporting obligation on the implementing Agency, NAPTIP. This chapter examines the efforts by Hi-MAT members and other stakeholders, in the implementation of the VAPP Act in FCT, detailing analysis of activities for the year 2021. Due to post Covid 19 effect, the Hi-MAT meeting in 2021 took place once on 24th February, 2021.

CHAPTER

2

The High-Level Multi-Agency Task Team (Hi-MAT)

The Hi-MAT is saddled with the following responsibilities:

- i Formulation of policies for the implementation of the VAPP Act.
- ii Provision of high-level policy and advocacy leadership for seamless collaboration with all relevant stakeholders in the implementation of the VAPP Act.
- iii Facilitating the collation, contribution and review of data by members of the Hi-MAT through securing the necessary political buy-in required for a smooth data sharing experience.
- iv Ensuring members contribute data regularly and with quality assurance steps as may be agreed by members.
- v Ensuring accountability and probity in the management of funds generated from the use of the National Sexual Offenders Database (NSOD)
- vi Giving approval for working tools such as templates, Information, Education and Communication (IEC) materials.
- vii Convening quarterly meetings to revise progress and plan for dissemination of VAPP Annual Implementation Report.
- viii Deployment of staff to serve as focal person for each Hi-MAT member agency
- ix Production/publishing of Regular report on activities of members on the Implementation of the VAPP Act.

Mandate and roles of Hi-MAT members

Federal Ministry of Women Affairs (FMWA)

The mandate of the FMWA is to advise government on gender and children's issues as well as issues affecting persons with disabilities and the elderly. The Federal Ministry also initiates policy guidelines and leads the process of ensuring gender equality and mainstreaming both at the national and international levels.

- i The Federal Ministry is charged with the responsibility of promoting women's advancement and coordinating the sustenance of gender equality in the plans, projects and programmes of the Federal Government.
- ii It initiates, implements and coordinates programmes on women's rights; has the duty of the administration of shelters for women victims of gender-based violence, as well as provide support services for survivors.
- iii The Federal Ministry is also required to review substantive and procedural laws that affect women.
- iv The Federal Ministry through its Women's Rights and Gender Development Division initiates implements and coordinates programmes in the areas of women's rights, protection and participation.
- v The Federal Ministry also advocates against gender-based violence, especially violence against women.

Table 2.1: Summary of 2021 Reported Cases in the FCT

VAPP offenses reported	3641 (National) 993 (States)
VAPP cases investigated	993
VAPP case referrals to Law enforcement Agencies	12 (States) 197 (National)
VAPP case referrals to other Stakeholders	360 (National) 50 (States)

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.2: Cases investigated in 2021

	Male	Female	Total
Number of cases investigated	3292	368	3,660
Number of cases investigated for Rape	179	0	179
Number of cases investigated for Incest	-	-	-
Number of cases investigated for spousal battery	315	12	327
Number of cases investigated for other VAPP offences			
Number of case referrals to other organizations			360

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.3: VAPP Cases convicted for 2021

	Male	Female	Total
Number of cases convicted	3	3	6
Number of persons convicted	0	0	0
Number of convictions for Incest	NA	NA	NA
Number of convictions for spousal battery	NA	NA	NA
Number of convictions for other VAPP offences	NA	NA	NA

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

The NHRC has the mandate with respect to the promotion and protection of human rights, investigation of alleged violation of human rights and enforcement of decisions.

NHRC has a Women, Children and Vulnerable Groups Department. The department is one of the investigative arms of the NHRC, which manages complaints of human rights violations regarding women, children and other groups. Part of the mandate of this department on sexual violence are the following:

- i Receive and document all related complaints directed to the department
- ii Invite the complainant to verify the claims in her complaint
- iii Liaise and collaborate with MDAs
- iv Refer complaints to relevant agencies, if necessary
- v Prepare reports on complaints for the approval of the Governing Council
- vi Contribute to policy formation related to its mandate

The NHRC has a complaints registry that has the responsibility of managing complaints. It also has an automated 24 hours call centre with toll-free phone number (+2348006472428) where survivors can report.

Table 2.4: Summary of 2021 Reported Cases in the FCT

Investigated Cases	Total
Number of cases investigated	3191
Number of cases investigated for Rape	155
Number of cases investigated for spousal battery	1341
Number of cases investigated for other VAPP offences	1695

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.5: Victims received and counselled

Number of victims received	3191
Number of victims counselled/ rehabilitated	3191
Number of victims reintegrated	NA
Number of victims referred to own organization	NA
Number of victims referred from another organization	NA
Number of victims empowered	NA

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Nigeria Police Force (NPF)

The NPF is mandated to protect peoples' lives and property; prevent, detect, and investigate crimes; and prosecute offenders. The NPF through its Gender Units, is saddled with the following responsibilities:

- i Advise the Inspector-General of Police on Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) and Violence Against Children (VAC) in Nigeria
- ii Conduct public awareness and sensitization on SGBV and VAC, and the need for timely reporting
- iii Train Gender Desk Officers across the various police commands, zonal offices and formations, on how to respond to SGBV and VAC
- iv Investigate and prosecute SGBV cases
- v Prevent and respond to incidents of SGBV and VAC in Nigeria
- vi Maintain database of perpetrators of SGBV and VAC
- vii Ensure effective partnership with stakeholders/NGOs working on SGBV and VAC
- viii Enforce and implement government policies and laws relating to the VAPP Act and the Child Rights Act

Table 2.6: Summary of 2021 Reported Cases in the FCT

Cases investigated	Total
Number of cases investigated	2237
Number of cases investigated for Rape	1983
Number of cases investigated for incest	55
Number of cases investigated for spousal battery	32
Number of cases investigated for other VAPP offences	10
Referrals	
Number of case referrals received	

Prosecution	Total
Number of VAPP Cases filed in court	1987
Number of prosecutions	153
Number of cases prosecuted for Rape	NA
Number of cases prosecuted for incest	NA
Number of cases prosecuted for spousal battery	NA
Number of cases prosecuted for other VAPP offences	NA
Conviction	Total
Number of persons convicted	187
Number of convictions for rape	145
Number of convictions for incest	
Number of convictions for spousal battery	
Number of convictions for other VAPP offences	

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

The Economic and Financial Crimes Commission (EFCC)

The Commission is empowered to prevent, investigate, prosecute and penalize economic and financial crimes and is charged with the responsibility of enforcing the provisions of other laws and regulations relating to economic and financial crimes. EFCC is also in the position to administer Polygraph on Post-Conviction Sex Offender Testing (PCSOT) to prevent re-offending. However, discussions are still underway to realize this potential.

The Nigerian Correctional Services (NCoS)

The function of the NCoS include amongst others, taking custody of all persons legally interned, providing safe, secure, and humane custody for inmates and providing support to facilitate the speedy disposal of cases of Awaiting Trial Persons. They also keep records of all convicted VAP offenders. In relation to the implementation of the VAPP Act, 2015, NCoS provides information of persons convicted under the Act.

Table 2.7: Summary of 2021 Convicted Persons in the FCT

S/N	STATE	CUSTODIAL CENTRE	CONVICTED			AWAITING TRIAL PERSONS			SUM TOTAL		
			Male	Female	TOTAL	Male	Female	TOTAL	Male (Total)	Female (Total)	Grand Total
		TOTAL	13		13	17		17	30		30
1	ABUJA (FCT)	Suleja	9		9	18		18	27		27
		Kuje				43		43	43		43
		Dukpa Farm	1		1				1		1
		TOTAL	10		10	61		61	71		71

Source: NCoS Report

National Center for Women Development (NCWD)

The National Centre for Women Development has the mandate to promote women's advancement through research, training and documentation and proactively work towards empowering Nigerian women socially, economically and politically for sustainable national development.

National Bureau of Statistics (NBS)

NBS is mandated to generate, on a continuous and sustainable basis, socio-economic statistics on all facets of development in Nigeria and section 42 of the VAPP Act, 2015 provides that a copy of the VAP Annual Implementation Report be deposited with the **NBS**. The first edition of the VAPP Report that is the 2020 report was deposited with the NBS in December 2021.

National Identity Management Commission (NIMC)

The National Identity Management Commission (NIMC) has the mandate to establish, own, operate, maintain, and manage the National Identity Database in Nigeria, register persons covered by the Act. The Commission provides information and data of violators of the Act.

Nigeria Security and Civil Defence Corps (NSCDC)

The primary function of the NSCDC is to protect lives and properties. The Corps is also involved in crisis resolutions. They are empowered to institute proceedings in accordance with provisions of the constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria against any person and persons suspected to have committed an offense, maintain an armed Squad in order to bear firearms among others to strengthen the corps in the discharge of its statutory duties.

Table 2.8: Summary of 2021 Reported Cases in the FCT

Individual investigated for VAPP offences in 2021	Male	Female	Total
Number of cases investigated	15	5	20
Number of cases investigated for Rape	5	0	5
Number of cases investigated for Incest			
Number of cases investigated for spousal battery	6		6
Number of cases investigated for other VAPP offences	4	5	9

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons (NAPTIP)

NAPTIP is mandated by section 44 of the VAPP Act to administer the provisions of the Act and collaborate with the relevant stakeholders including faith-based organizations. The Agency also has the mandate of implementing the Trafficking in Persons (Prohibition) Enforcement and Administration Act, 2015 (as re-enacted). NAPTIP implements the VAPP Act through the coordination of its multi-disciplinary departments that is, the VAPP Department, Legal and Prosecution, Counselling & Rehabilitation, Public Enlightenment and the Rapid Response Squad.

Table 2.9: Summary of 2021 Reported Cases in the FCT

Cases investigated	Male	Female	Total
Number of cases investigated	214	490	704
Number of cases investigated for Rape	4	71	75
Number of cases investigated for incest	0	9	9
Number of cases investigated for spousal battery	2	196	198
Number of cases investigated for other VAPP offences	151	211	362
Number of case referrals			19
Number of case referrals received			41

Prosecution	Total
Number of cases filed in court	22
Number of cases prosecuted	11
Number of cases prosecuted for Rape	2
Number of cases prosecuted for incest	2
Number of cases prosecuted for spousal battery	7
Number of cases prosecuted for other VAPP offences	1
Number of conviction (FCT)	1

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.10: Victim's Data	Total
Number of victims received (children)	92
Number of victims received (Adult)	304
Number of victims counselled and reunited (children)	92
Number of victims counselled (Adult)	304

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Analysis of Cases Handled by Hi-MAT Members

Table 2.11: Number of Individuals Investigated for Rape

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	7
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	179
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	75
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	155
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	5
Total	421

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.12: Number of Cases Investigated

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	918
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	3660
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	704
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	3191
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	20
Total	8473

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.13: Number of Individuals Investigated for Rape

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	7
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	179
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	75
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	155
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	5
Total	350

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.14: Number of Cases Investigated for Spousal Battery

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	60
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	327
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	198
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	1341
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	6
Total	1932

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.15: Number of Cases Investigated for Other VAPP Offences

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	0
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	0
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	362
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	1695
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	9
Total	2066

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.16: Number of Case Referrals

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	3
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	360
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	19
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	0
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	0
Total	382

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Table 2.17: Number of Case Referrals Received from Another Organization

Name of Organizations	Total
FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team	6
Federal Ministry of Women Affairs	0
Legislative Advocacy Coalition on Violence Against Women (LACVAW) Initiative	0
Federal Ministry of Justice	0
NAPTIP	364
National Bureau of Statistics	0
National Human Rights Commission	0
Nigeria Security & Civil Defense Corps	0
Total	370

Source: 2021 Reporting Template

Other Activities by Hi-MAT Members

National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons

- i** **Survivors Co-Mentoring Platform:** On the 8th of December, 2021 NAPTIP launched a Survivors Co-Mentoring Platform at the Agency's shelter. This event was curated as part of the healing process for victims of human trafficking and survivors of SGBV. The platform is driven by survivors; they speak to each other, and it provides an opportunity for survivors to share their needs and how NAPTIP can best serve them. The Survivors Co-Mentoring Platform is a hybrid session that takes place at the Agency's shelter.
- ii** **VAPP Annual Implementation Report:** NAPTIP launched and presented the maiden VAPP Annual Implementation Report on December 4, 2021, in Abuja in accordance with section 42 of the VAPP Act with support from the European Union Funded Rule of Law and Anti-Corruption Program, implemented by British Council.

iii 16 Days of Activism: The 2021 16 days of activism with the theme “Orange the world: End Violence against women Now!!” was marked with activities by all stakeholders. The Campaign started with a live radio Programme on Cool FM where the Director General of NAPTIP Unveiled activities for the 16 Days of Activism. This was followed immediately with a Road walk by NAPTIP, its stakeholders and partners, the road walk is to publicize zero tolerance and zero impunity for VAPP Offenders. During the campaign NAPTIP also had a Football match (Men and Women Teams); Schools campaign against SGBV with the launch at Federal Government Girls College, Abaji which is aimed at supporting SGBV Clubs in Secondary Schools through age appropriate peer to peer preventive education approach. During the Visit to Federal Government Girls College Abaji, The Director General also inducted NAPTIP’s Youngest Ambassador Ms Maryam Babatunde who has been a voice within her peers to fight against SGBV.

The Agency also conducted a social media competition seeking submission of a 90 seconds video on the theme “Sexual and Gender Based Violence” The Top three skits were selected and prizes awarded to the winners. The 1st Position went to Ayam Princess Prisca, 2nd Position went to Charles Sam Obu, while 3rd Position went to Diamond Sam Obu. Sensitization programme on Rights Radio on VAPP Series was also carried out during the 16 days of activism, the series focused on sensitizing the public on the VAPP Act and other issues around SGBV. As part of activities for the 16 days of activism, the Agency in partnership with the European Union funded Rule of Law and Anti-Corruption organized an SGBV Mock Court session to develop survivor centered justice processes. This session took place from November 29th - December 1st 2021. The Mock SGBV Court was held simultaneously with the Counselling and Legal Clinic for SGBV survivors, this clinic provided rape and sexual assault counselling, legal advice & assistance.

iv NAPTIP Short Films on SGBV: The Agency Drama club produced and launched a short film on Violence against persons titled “**Watch out and Speak out for Justice**”. The short film was launched during the 2021 16 days of activism and streamed on YouTube. The Drama Club also produced a stage drama Gender Flip Side which was launched and presented during the launch of the NAPTIP Gender Policy in March 2021.

v NAPTIP in collaboration with UN Women launched the NAPTIP Gender Policy on March 2021. The Policy aims to strengthen gender clauses and mainstreaming of gender into policies, legislation, programmes, and operations of NAPTIP.

vi NAPTIP in collaboration with its partners conducted capacity building for the Media community in Nigeria on 10th December, 2021 at Keffi; Nasarawa State. The training was on the need for the media to give prominence to reportage of Violence against persons. A total of 30 Media Practitioners were trained.

Nigeria Police Force (NPF)

- i Capacity Building:** The Nigerian Police force conducted training and retraining of all its gender desk officers across the 36 states including the FCT. A total of 46 Gender Desk officers were trained on VAPP Act. The NPF also trained and retrained 90 Gender divisional officers in Lagos, Kano and Enugu.

2021 Hi-MAT Event Photos



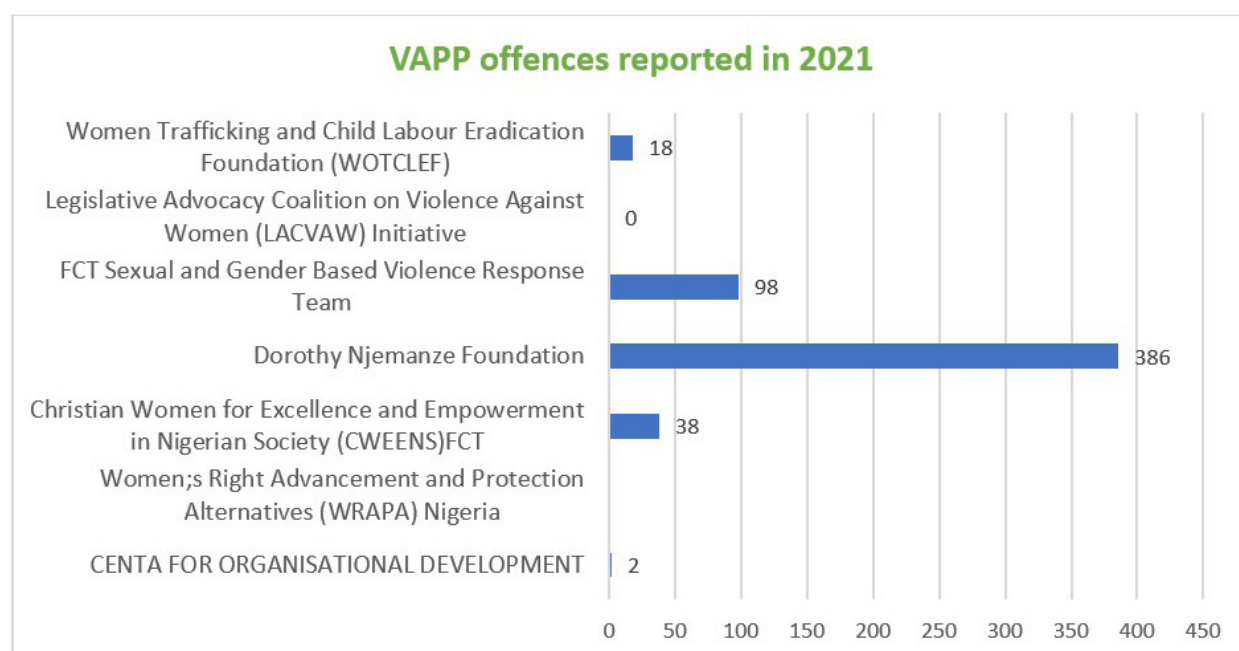
Implementation of the VAPP Act by the Service Provider Accountability Resource Committee (SPARC)

CHAPTER

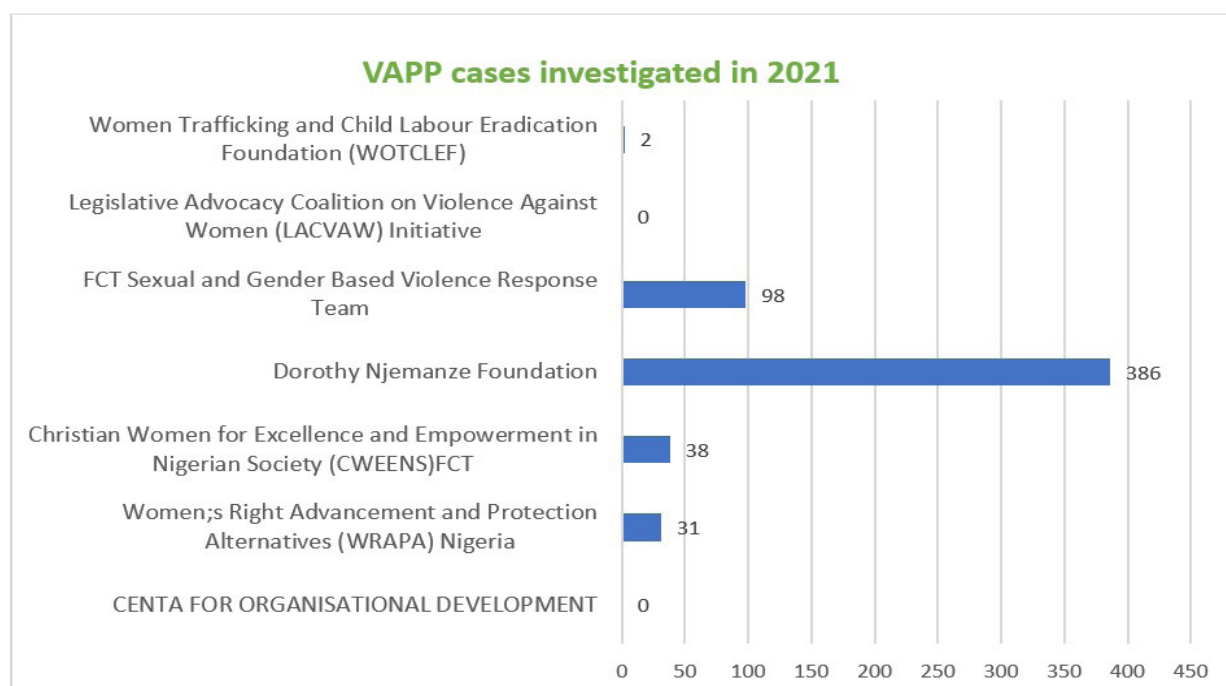
3

Service providers are organizations and paralegals who render services considered necessary to create safe spaces, prevent, report, or treat cases of violence against person as stipulated under the VAPP Act. They are governmental, Non-Governmental Organizations, Faith-Based Organizations, voluntary and charitable associations/ institutions, organizations providing shelter, homes, counselling, legal, financial, vocational, educational, medical or other assistance to victims and survivors of all forms of domestic and sexual violence.

3.1 Analysis of SPARC VAPP Implementation

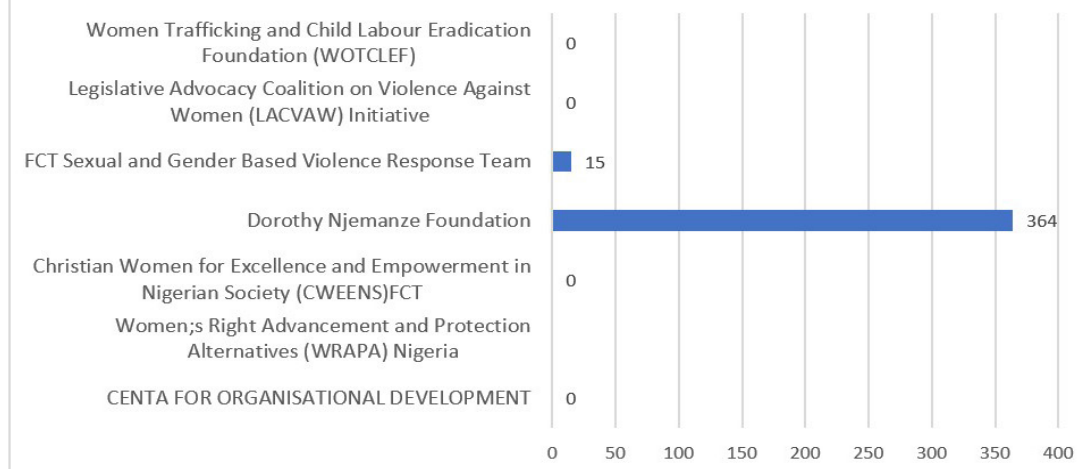


Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



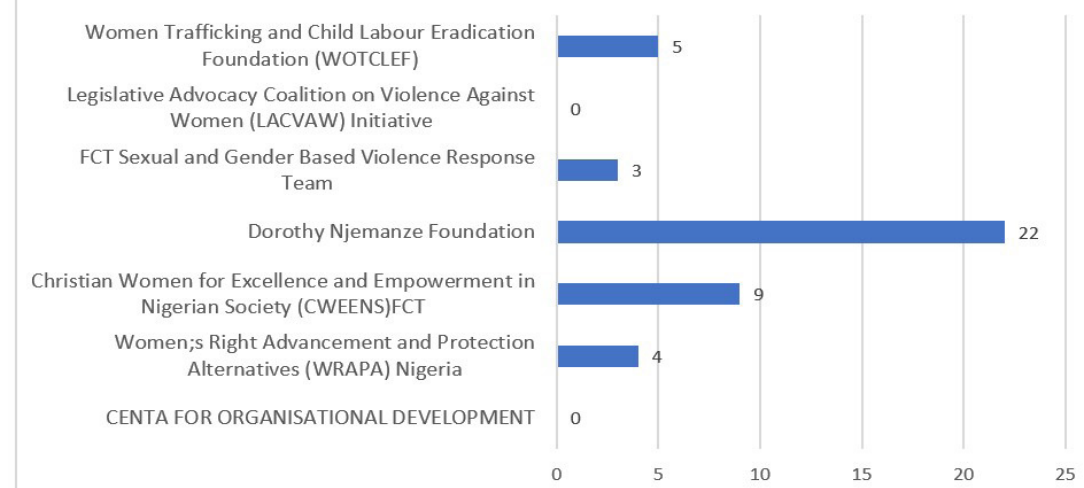
Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template

VAPP referrals to Law enforcement organisation for prosecution in 2021



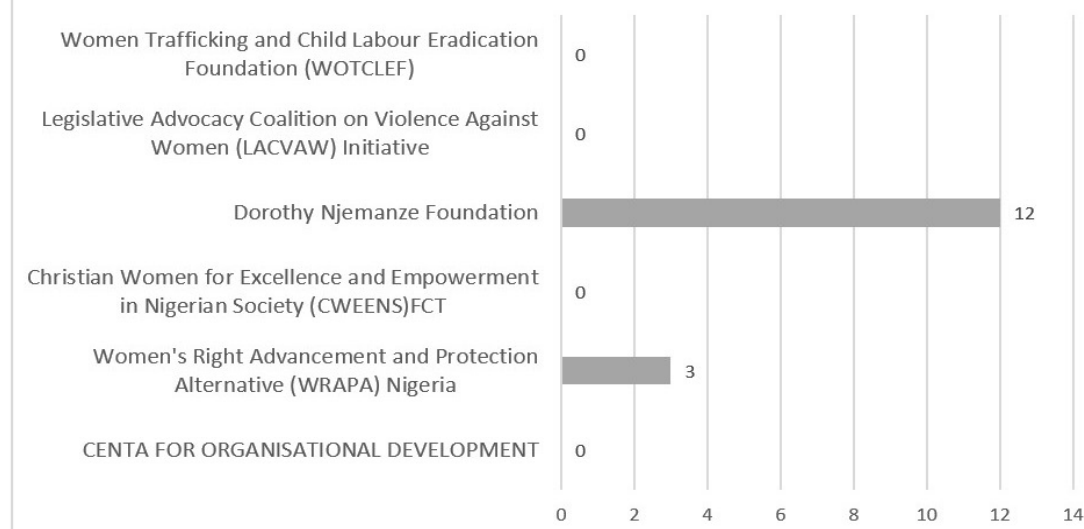
Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template

VAPP cases referrals to other Stakeholders in 2021



Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template

VAPP Cases filed in court in 2021



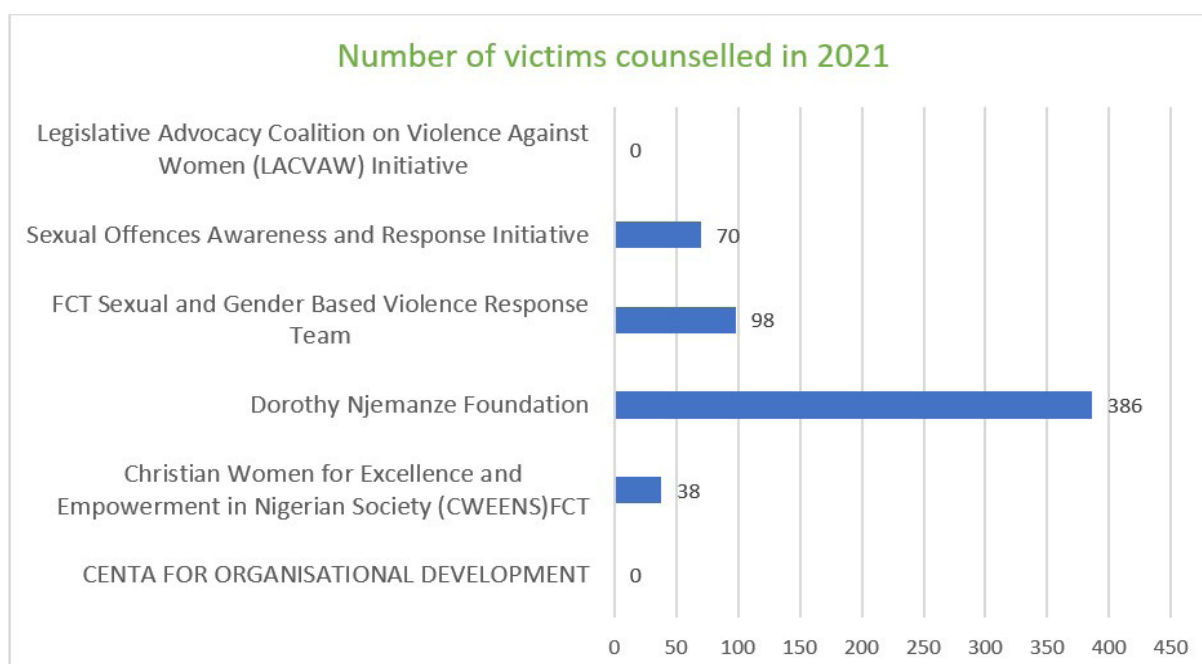
Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



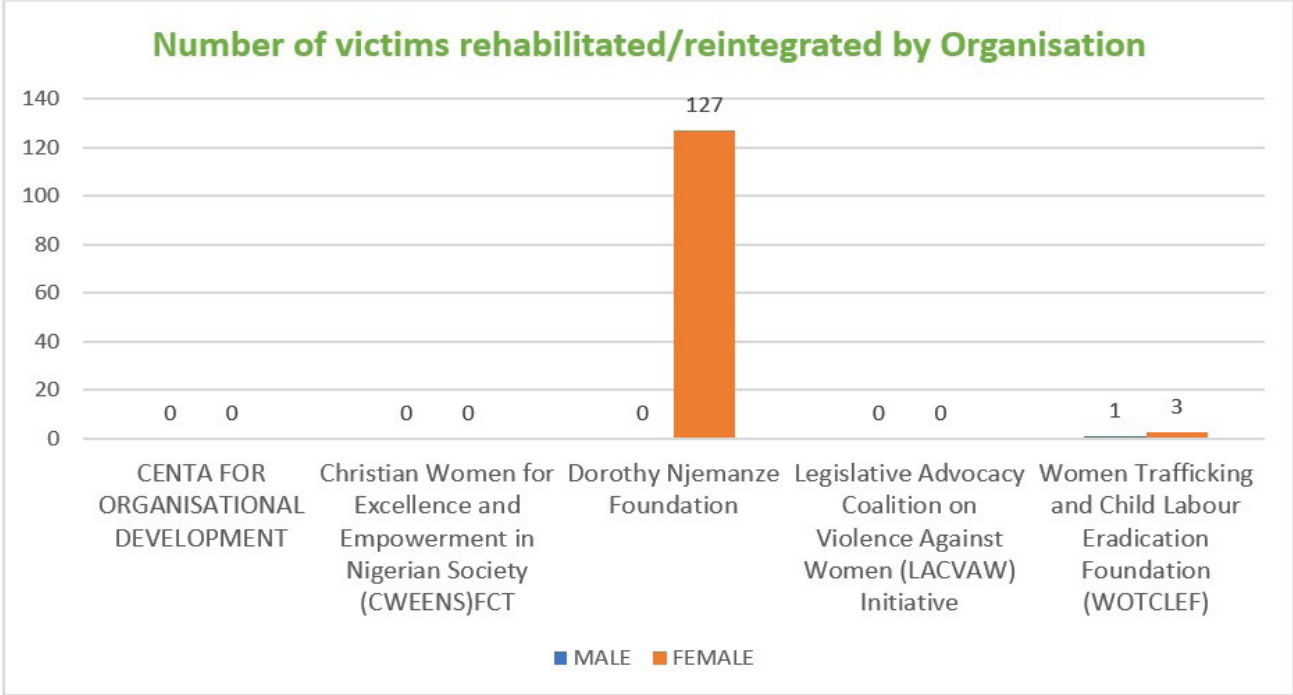
Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



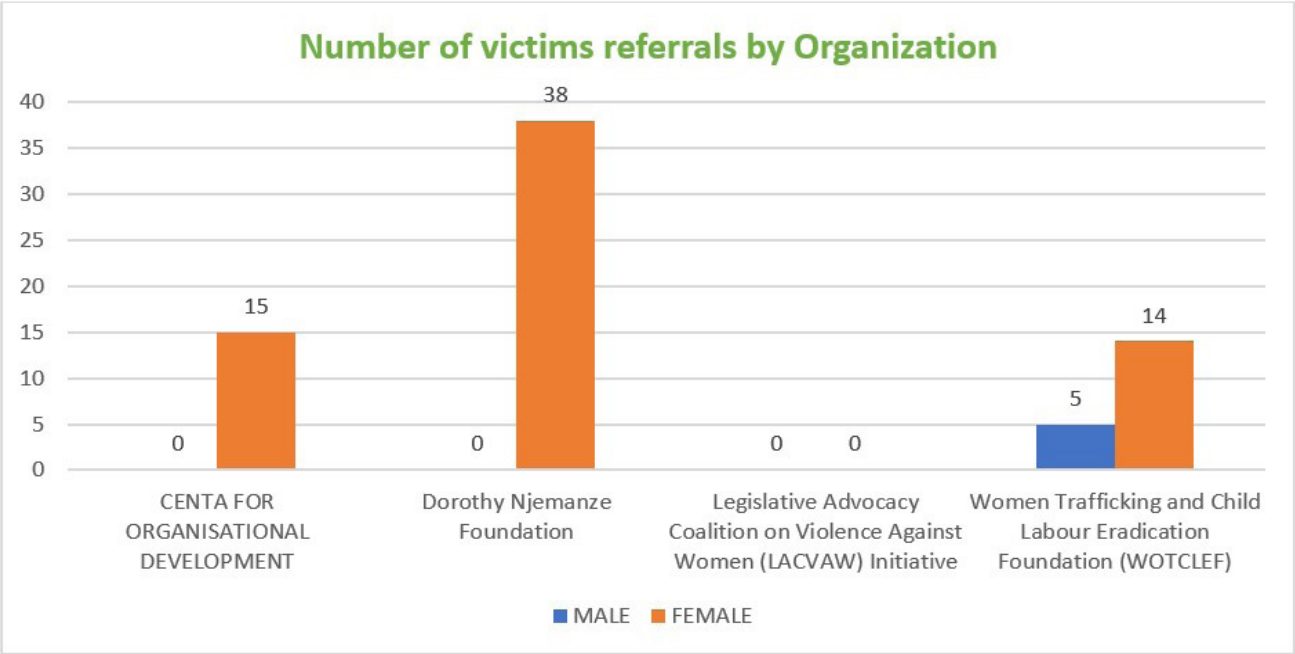
Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template



Source: VAPP 2021 Reporting Template

Sexual Assault Referral Centres (SARC)

A coordinated and collaborative approach to sexual assault provides that much needed reassurance and support, which in turn improves survivors' engagement to facilitate healing, and increase the potential for acquiring justice. SARCs are developed to provide a 'one-stop shop' for survivors of rape and sexual violence so they do not have to navigate multiple services. It also ensures that survivors have fair access to good quality services.³

Services provided by SARCs include: counselling, medical, forensic, legal as well as psycho-social support, free of charge. The goals of SARCs are to limit the physical and mental health consequences of rape and sexual assault by providing free, accessible, multi-Agency, forensically secured service for survivors as enumerated below:

- i Confidentiality, privacy and a client-focused service orientation;
- ii Unbiased information;
- iii Immediate emergency medical treatment
- iv Forensic medical examination services by specially trained doctors and midwives who prepare reports that are admissible as evidence where appropriate;
- v Advice on Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs), including HIV and the risk of pregnancy;
- vi Immediate and continuous counselling support including risk of harm and vulnerability assessment from people experienced in the specialized field of counselling victims of sexual abuse;
- vii Support in contacting the police, social welfare department, or Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) where appropriate based on the demand of the victim;
- viii Advice and ongoing support throughout any police investigation and prosecution.
- ix follow-up services;
- x 24-hour telephone helpline.

The above services should be available irrespective of whether the survivor reports to the police. SARCs emphasize choice and options, meaning that all procedures and options must be explained. Survivors should be able to choose whether to have a forensic examination and evidence collection or not.

³ National Guide for the Establishment and Management of Sexual Assault Referral Centres in Nigeria. Developed by Dr Fatima Waziri-Azi, pg. 4, 2021

FCT SARC STATISTICS

December 2020 - December 2021

i. Abuja Bwari SARC Monthly Statistics

Month	Dec-20	Jan-21	Feb-21	Mar-21	Apr-21	May-21	Jun-21	Jul-21	Aug-21	Sep-21	Oct-21	Nov-21	Dec-21	Total
Clients Gender														
Female	6	9	5	9	3	7	6	5	5	1	1	6	4	67
Male	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	2
TOTAL number of clients:	7	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	5	1	1	6	4	69
Clients Age														
0-17 years	6	5	3	7	2	5	7	5	5	1	1	3	3	53
18 years and above	1	4	2	2	1	2	0	0	0	0	0	3	1	16
TOTAL number of clients:	7	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	5	1	1	6	4	69
Client Services provided														
Counselling	7	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	5	1	1	6	4	69
Medical	7	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	5	1	1	6	4	69
Medical / Forensic Reports to Police	2	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	0	0	1	6	2	56
Legal Outcomes														0
Arrests Made	6	9	5	9	3	7	7	5	5	1	1	6	2	66
Charged to Court	1	8	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				14
Convictions		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				0
Settled Out		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				0

ii. Abuja Cece Yara SARC

Month	Jan-21	Feb-21	Mar-21	Apr-21	May-21	Jun-21	Jul-21	Aug-21	Sep-21	Oct-21	Nov-21	Dec-21	Total
Female	1	0	2	3	3	2	3	3	3	0	2	3	25
Male	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	2	1	0	4	1	10
TOTAL number of clients:	1	0	2	3	3	2	5	5	4	0	6	4	35
Clients Age													
0-17 years	1	0	2	3	3	2	4	4	4	0	6	4	33
18 years and above	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	0	0	0	2
TOTAL number of clients:	1	0	2	3	3	2	5	5	4	0	6	4	35
Client Services provided													
Counselling	2	0	2	1	0	0	1	4	2	0	2	2	16
Medical	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	2
Medical / Forensic Reports to Police	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	3
Legal Outcomes													0
Arrests Made	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	0				3
Charged to Court	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				0
Convictions	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				0
Settled Out of Court	1	0	2	3	3	0	0	0	0				9

Source: EU Rule of Law and Anti-Corruption (ROLAC), Implemented by British Council

Other Activities by SPARC Members

1 **Christian Women for Excellence and Empowerment in Nigerian Society (CWEENS)FCT**

- Capacity building for CWEENS FCT Staff and Exco on Response to SGBV
- Christian Women for Excellence and Empowerment in Nigerian Society (CWEENS)FCT developed an Anti-Bullying policy.
- Undertook Research work on Sexual and Gender based violence.

2 **FCT Sexual and Gender Based Violence Response Team**

- 1-day capacity building of relevant stakeholders including CSOs and social welfare officers on Elaborated Guidelines and Tools in the implementation of law like VAPP Act, 2015 and other policies. Date: 23rd March, 2021, venue: Custodian Hotel Gombe Jewel Hotel Building, Wuse 2, Abuja.
- Capacity building for 48 stakeholders for a one-day TOT for teachers in the school for the disabled, judges and prosecutors and social workers on the prevention and response guidelines and reporting tools on SGBV against women and girls.
- Conducted a two-day workshop for 40 stakeholders to develop a referral pathway in the FCT for the elimination of all forms of violence against women and girls

3 **Centa for Organisational Development**

- Worked with Women Advocates Research and Argumentation Center (WARDAC) to deliver capacity training services on VAPP Act, 2015 as consultants to over 500 women in Kebbi, Yobe, Adamawa and FCT.
- Worked with Network of Nigeria women mediators, to carry out capacity building training online for counsellors and mediators in the FCT number for over 50 persons.

4 **Legislative Advocacy Coalition on Violence Against Women (LACVAW) Initiative**

- Capacity building has widely been conducted by our members – FIDA Nigeria and WRAPA in States across the nation.
- **Town Hall Meetings:** Town hall meetings at the Area Councils and Advocacy Visits to National Assembly and Ministries Departments and Agencies were carried out by Legislative Advocacy Coalition on Violence Against Women (LACVAW)
- Conducted Research on Baseline and Data Collection.

5 **Abiodun Essiet Initiative for Girls (AEIG)**

- Advocacy visits with the Chairman Abuja Municipal Area Council (AMAC) and wives of FCT Traditional Rulers to build partnership and collaboration to fight VAP in the FCT in 30th of November, 2021.
- Conducted Baseline study in the 6 Area councils of the FCT to determine the prevalence of VAP in the FCT from the 20th of December, 2021 to February, 2022.
- Conducted stakeholders mapping to identify original inhabitants' stakeholders and other relevant stakeholders to engage in the gender inclusion and SGBV response project in 13th November, 2021
- Conducted GBV emotional support and response for 3 victims on the 24th, 30th and 31st December, 2021

6 **Dorathy Njemanze Foundation**

- Created Audio Visual Messages translated to sign language and pidgin English.
- Compiled comics to sensitize Internally Displaced Persons (IDP) on issues related to VAP in hausa, Kanuri, fuldude, Arabic, English and pidgin.
- Constant awareness of the linkages between different issues and the VAPP, for example, the cross dressing bill. We were part of the campaign because it has tendencies to violate the rights of lots of people. DNF feels it is a targeted thing for women because they are existing conversations about why women should not wear trousers.

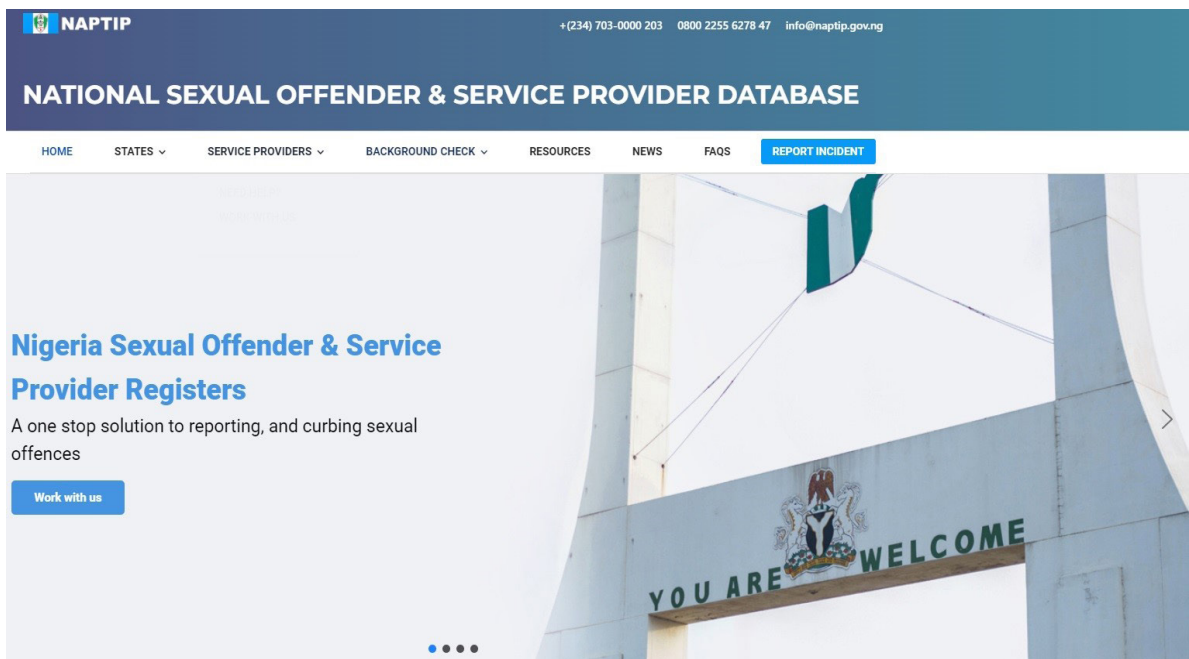


CHAPTER 4

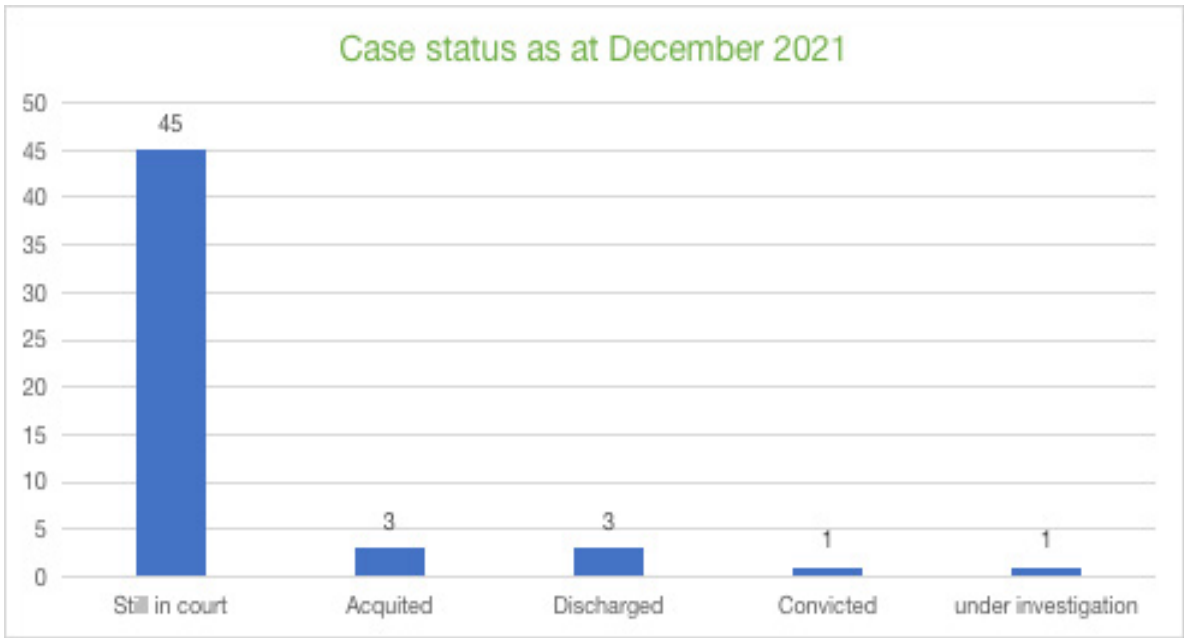
Nigeria Sexual Offender Database (NSOD)

The NSOD is made up of two registers which are; Sexual Offender Register (SOR) and the Service Provider Register (SPR) . The NSOD is meant to be linked to the States Registers and made accessible to members of the public and security agencies. It has layers of accessibility, with data of convicted persons available directly on the website, while other categories (such as cases reported, Cases under investigation, Cases filed in court for prosecution) are not available online for public views. Such cases are available only on demand and need to know basis. This register serves as:

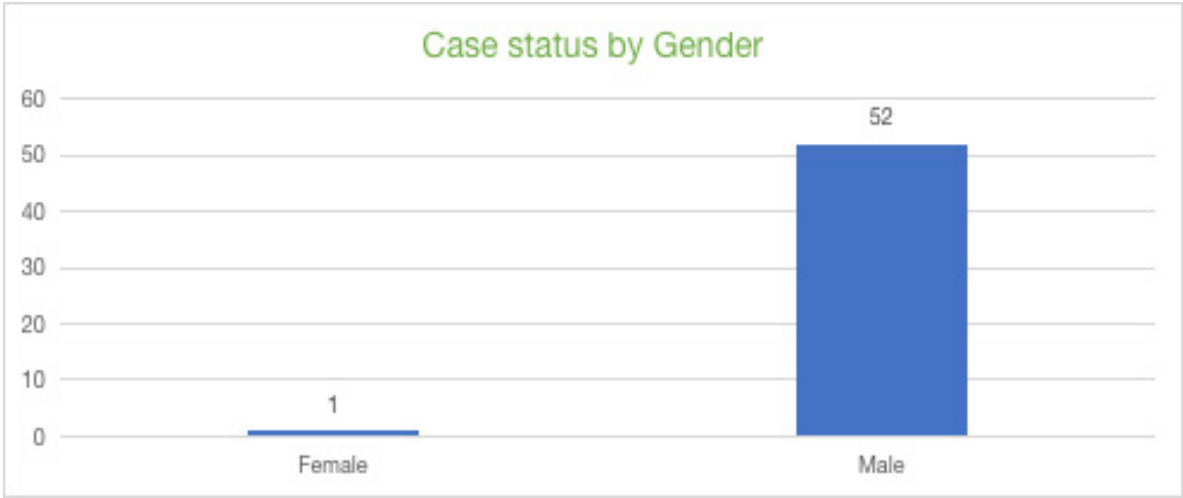
1. A biometric database to share information that is verifiable, trans border verifiable information of offenders to prevent repeat offending
2. As a source to verify profiles of would-be employees in sensitive positions such as child-care and teaching, this assumes that schools have access to the register
3. A deterrence to repeat offending or recidivism, as offenders are named and shamed.



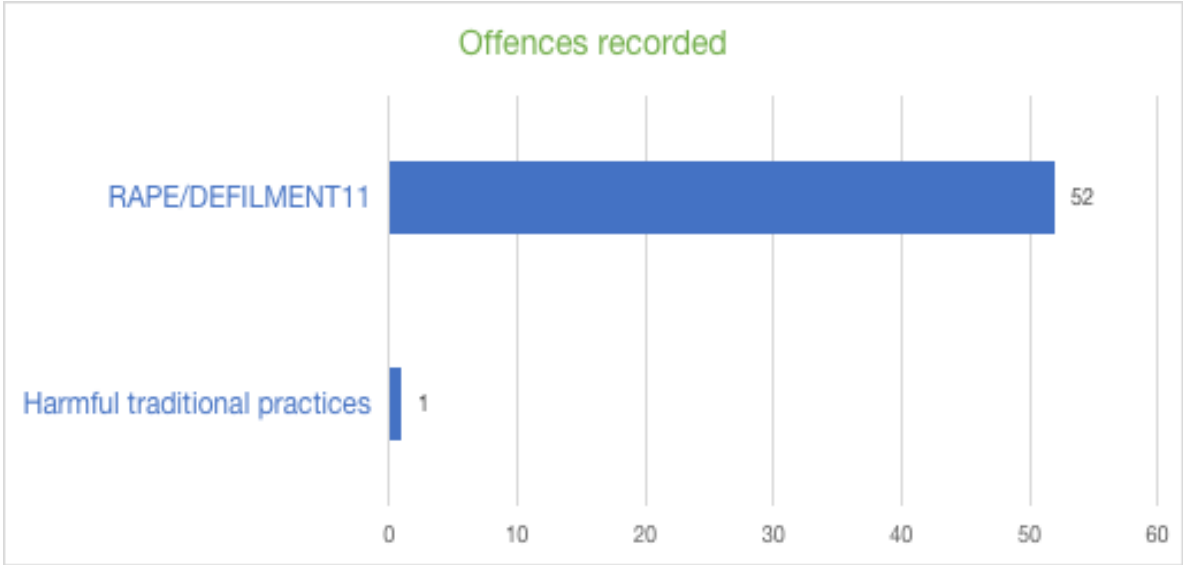
As at December 2021 Edo, Delta and Kano States linked their register to the NSOD with the following records:



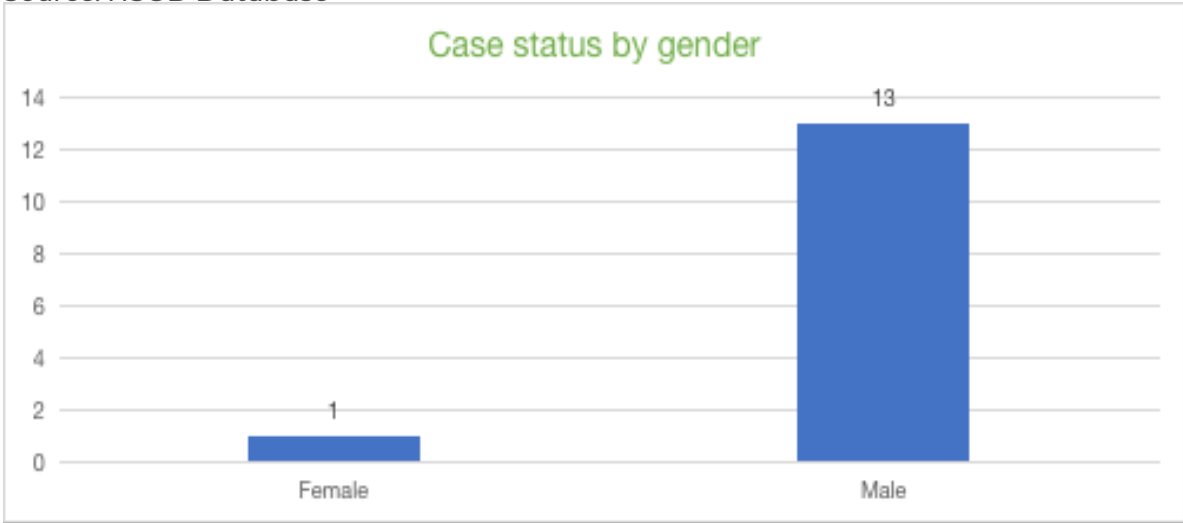
Source: NSOD Database



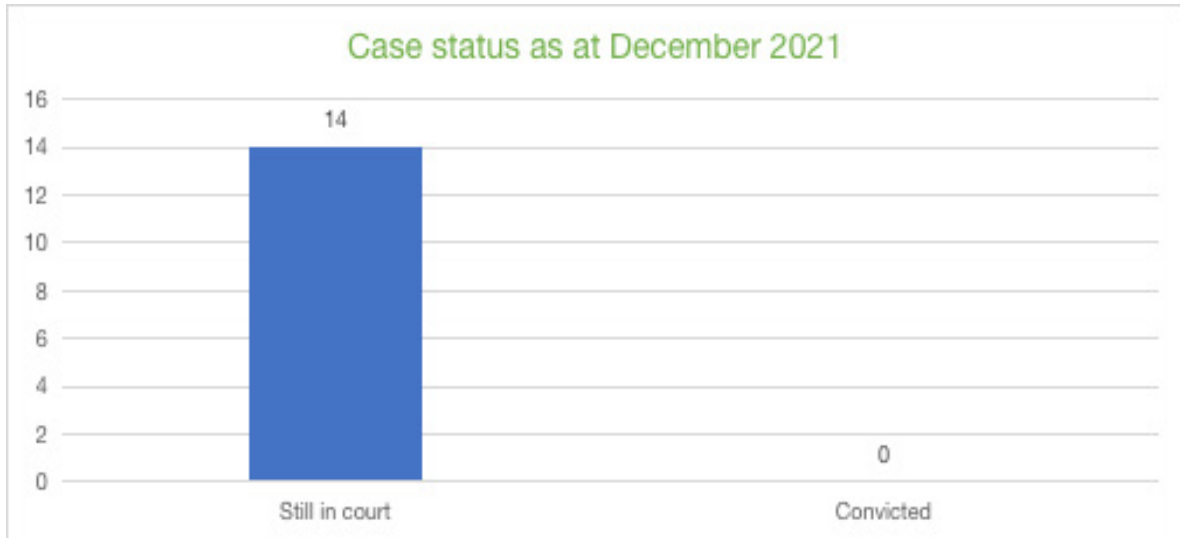
Source: NSOD Database



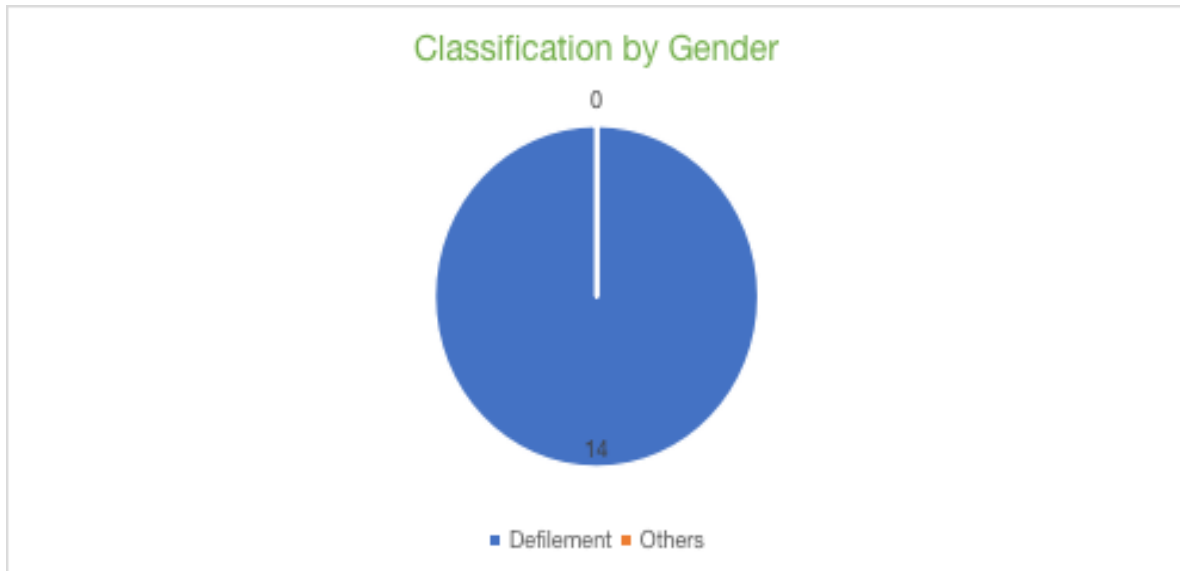
Source: NSOD Database



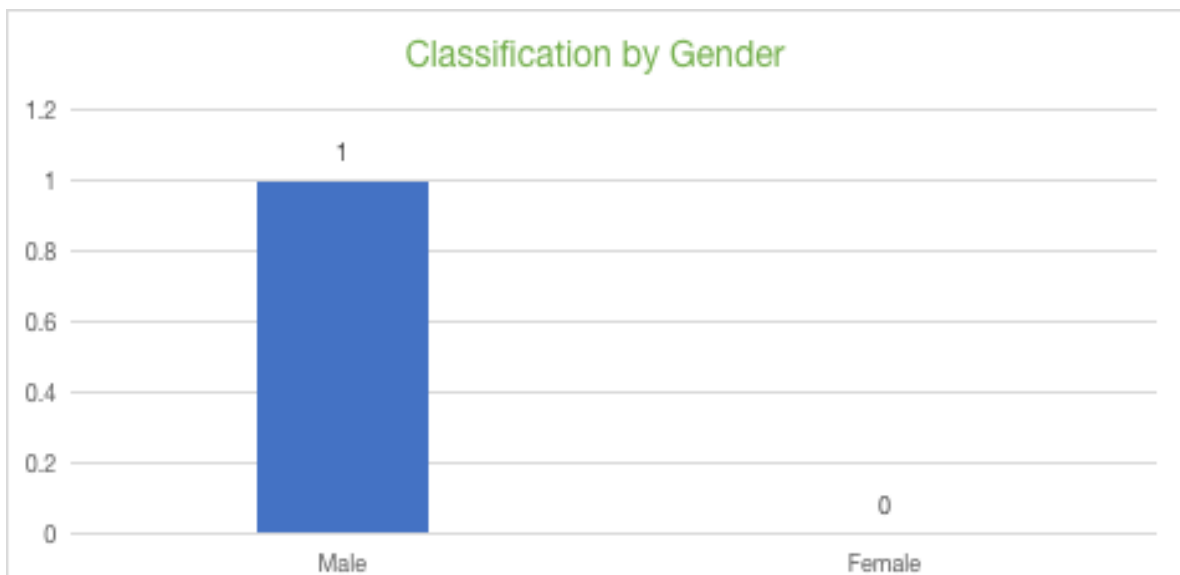
Source: NSOD Database



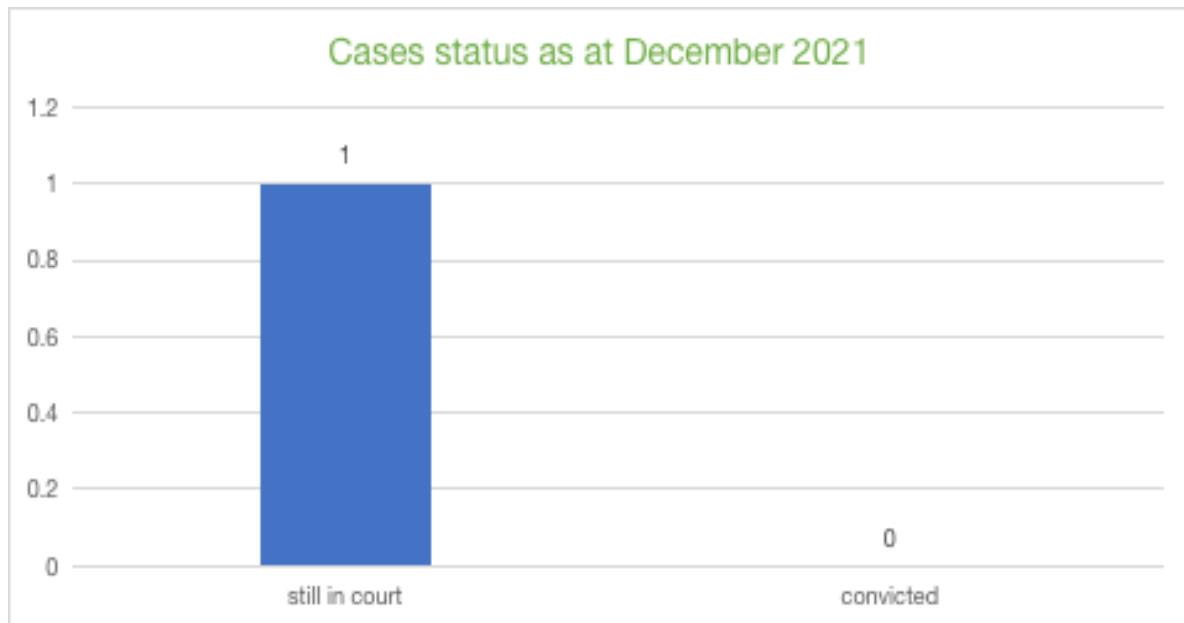
Source: NSOD Database



Source: NSOD Database



Source: NSOD Database



Source: NSOD Database



Source: NSOD Database

Lessons Learned, Challenges and Recommendations

There is concerted effort by stakeholders in implementing the VAPP Act in the FCT. From the analysis of the data presented by key implementers; notwithstanding the post Covid effect, the reportage of cases indicates that there is increase in the awareness of VAP offences amongst the populace.

CHAPTER

5

Trends in VAPP Reporting

The analysis of various stakeholder's report presupposes that there was increase in the reportage of spousal battery, many of which did not get to court (NAPTIP report), while that of NPF shows that cases of spousal battery were minimal. The fact that there's a high reportage of spousal battery raises a serious concern. This could be as a result of some of the challenges which are highlighted hereinafter, for instance societal, cultural, religious interference and fear of stigmatization or fear of being tagged a troublemaker who wants to bring shame to the family.

Furthermore, the data indicates some disparity when it comes to prosecution of rape cases. For NAPTIP, more cases of rape ended up in court, with 12 out of the 22 cases filed in court being rape cases; while for the NPF, out of the 1987 rape cases that were filed in court, only 153 were prosecuted (NPF data). Meaning, less than 8% of the cases reported reached a logical conclusion.

The data further revealed that referrals to organizations empowered by the Act to deal with cases of violence against persons were minimal by almost all stakeholders. Also, the data presented by some organizations were not disaggregated, proving to be a challenge for the proper analysis and measurement of impact for the entire activities for the year 2021.

The data from the report also shows that cases of Spousal battery outweigh cases of Rape and incest but cases of Rape received more prosecutions leading to more convictions; this shows that the awareness being created by various stakeholders on the VAPP Act has led to an increase in the reportage of Spousal Battery across board.

However, this has not been translated in Prosecutions which most times is due to high turnover in the withdrawal of cases of spousal battery due to family, religious and societal pressure.

Lessons Learned

1. In 2021, it was reported that there was no structured referral pathway which affected referrals and as such led to a limited referral of cases to appropriate organizations for intervention.
2. The inability of major stakeholders to appreciate their mandate led to responsibility of stakeholders overlapping, some important activities left undone and a lot of cases being mismanaged.
3. Post Covid registered lots of cases which awakened the call to all key stakeholders to collaborate, synergize and work as one.
4. Protection officers in the Area councils of the FCT experienced lack of cooperation from the Law Enforcement Officers in the Area Council, this could be attributed to regular transfer and posting of trained LEA Officers.
5. The lack of a centralized data based system for the collation of reported cases across key responding agencies has consistently led to inefficient disaggregated data pool.

Challenges

— **Funding:** Lack of Sustainable Funding to enable partners support survivors to seek Justice and lack of budget line for key players responsible for the successful implementation of the VAPP to execute their mandates.

— **Post COVID 19 Effect:** This had a tremendous impact on cases of VAPP due to a backlog of cases which could not be followed up because of the lockdown and as such gave rise to low convictions.

— **Culture of silence:** The concealment of acts of violence due to stigmatization and rejection by family and society deters victims from speaking up or seek for help for fear of rejection. The pressure on victims lead to recanting of statements by victims. Interference and disruption of proceedings by parents, community, religious and traditional leaders often contribute to the culture of silence.

— **Psycho-Social Support:** There is limited access to psycho-social support for victims in FCT. The need for centers offering psycho-social support for victims of violence against persons as psycho-social supports are essential components of the comprehensive package of care which aims to protect or promote psycho-social well-being as well as prevent or treat mental disorders among survivors of VAP. A lot of victims exposed to Violence against persons experience emotional/Psychological or mental health problems and would need psycho social support to help reintegrate them back. This could be through Counselling, Group Therapy, Play Therapy, dance Therapy etc. The Psycho social support helps victim receive compassionate and ongoing psychological assistance to heal their emotional pain and sufferings from the abuser. Therefore, efforts should be made to provide adequate psycho social rehabilitation as well as take care of dependents of victims without which these victims might not have the courage to persist with efforts to secure justice.

— **Sexual Assault Referral Centre:** There is only one SARC in the FCT, Located in Bwari. This Center is not easily accessible by victims of sexual abuse in other Area councils. Considering the geographical size of FCT, It is important to have at least 1 SARC in each Area Council as this will provide easily assessable support services for victims of SGBV. These centers would also enable stakeholders have a more coordinated response, intervention and verifiable statistics on the issues. The SARC will also help increase the conviction of rape and other sexual assault conviction cases in the FCT through the provision of forensic evidence to support prosecution in court or help preserve evidence, even where survivors are not yet ready for prosecution.

National Sex Offenders Database (NSOD): There is an alarming reluctance by service providers to register on the service provider database for fear of proper scrutiny of the services they provide. Effective utilization of the NSOD can only be attained when service providers register, undergo vetting, engage and navigate the NSOD portal. Also, there is a slow pace by Hi-MAT members to record their data on the NSOD when there is an arrest or conviction of sexual offenders in FCT and this has led to a massive gap in terms of available and reliable data. There are limited features on the NSOD. Being the first database on Violence against persons there are features which are not there and this does not give room for in-depth analysis of the information stored in the database. The Service Provider Database also needs to be expanded to accommodate more queries for analysis which include dates service provider registered their organisation on the database. There is also need to upgrade the database to cover offences from state laws since other states are linked to the NSOD.

Delay In Reporting Cases: Late reporting of sexual offences to the relevant Authorities, makes it a bit complicated to gather good evidence against the suspect. Notwithstanding the provisions of the procedural law with regards to statute limitation on criminal offences, gathering evidence of SGBV is usually advised to be handled timeously for effective prosecution.

Lengthy Court process: Delays in our court system which could be as a result of incessant adjournment of cases, unforeseen exigencies like Covid-19 lockdown, court strikes etc could lead to unwillingness of victims to testify in court, withdrawal of such cases or even suspects jumping bail and absconding. These forestalls and frustrates the progress of VAP cases in Court and can make perpetrators go free.

Capacity Building: Inadequate Capacity building on investigative skills, psycho-social services, prosecutorial skills etc. There is need for training and retraining for Law Enforcement Agencies, Judges, care-givers and other stakeholders on the implementation of the VAPP Act (2015). Training must be on the job and should be tailored to meet ever evolving best practices and new challenges. Medical Personnel should also be trained on how to attend to victims of sexual violence.

Data Collection: There is an urgent need to improve the mechanism for data mining which should include capturing and reporting dis-aggregated data as lack of comprehensive gender dis-aggregated data can frustrate planning and programming. The NSOD should be activated as a one stop shop for SGBV Data and Hi-MAT members should encourage the increased use among its members. All data from SARCs and service providers should be domiciled on the NSOD. States are strongly encouraged to collaborate with NAPTIP to ensure effective On boarding on the NSOD as this will help the country have a harmonized database for vetting exercises, planning and programming.

Recommendations

In providing access to justice for victims of domestic and sexual violence it is recommended that the executive, judiciary, National Assembly and all key stakeholders in the Implementation of the VAPP Act should:

- 1 Ensure the adoption and effective implementation of the VAPP Act in all states across Nigeria.
- 2 Undertake comprehensive law reform and ensure that the provisions of statutory, Islamic and customary laws are in compliance with international human rights laws.
- 3 Establish more shelters across the country and ensure their accessibility to survivors, both in rural and urban areas.
- 4 Provide appropriate continuous training for law enforcement officers, members of the judiciary and staff of relevant government ministries, departments and agencies working with survivors or perpetrators, in prevention and detection of sexual violence.
- 5 Provide adequate budgetary allocation to NAPTIP and other relevant stakeholders to effectively carry out its mandate under the VAPP Act.
- 6 Provide necessary training and resources to hospitals, to ensure that they are able to provide appropriate medical care for survivors of rape and other forms of sexual and gender-based violence.
- 7 Establish more SARCs, at least one SARC in each Area Council of the FCT.
- 8 Ensure that cases of violence against persons are fairly and promptly tried in court.
- 9 Provide adequate protection for victims in courts, during investigation and the accredited service providers within the Area Council in ensuring that victims or survivors of violence have easy access to justice, psycho-social, housing, medical and physical care.
- 10 The need to develop a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for all key stakeholders/Implementers of the VAPP Act to identify and guide them on the implementation the VAPP Act.

- 11 A Post-Conviction Sexual Offender Testing (PCSOT) to deter repeat offenders should be considered and mainstreamed into the criminal justice system. PCSOT motivates individuals to be truthful, about their sexual behaviors, possible recent relapses and high risk conduct. PCSOT is an effective and important management and treatment tool that can help lower sexual and general criminal recidivism during supervision and treatment
- 12 There is need for an increase in awareness campaign in the rural areas of the FCT because grassroots initiatives are able to best respond to incidents with a culturally sensitive approach. Violence against women and girls must be seen as a community issue that needs solving at the community level.

2021 ANNUAL VAPP REPORT COMMITTEE MEMBERS

1. Prof. Fatima Waziri Azi	Director General NAPTIP
2. Ijeoma Mary Amugo	Director VAP Department
3. Murjanatu Kamaldeen	SA to Director General
4. Edeoga Chinenye Audrey	VAPP Coordinator
5. Magnus Emeh	Head, NAPTIP Rapid Response Squad
6. Isa Abdulkarim	ICT Department
7. Arinze Mbanefo	Legal & Prosecution Department
8. Mildred Nwabuebo	VAP Department
9. Ja'afaru Ayitogo	Legal and Prosecution Department
10. Oluwakeji Lebi	Research and Program Development Department
11. Rasheed Olatunji	Research and Program Development Department
12. Rose Paul	VAP Department

HI-MAT WORKING GROUP MEMBERS

13. Victoria Lar	Federal Ministry of Women affairs (FMWA)
14. Hadiza ALi Dagabana	National Identity Management Commission (NIMC)
15. Damilola B. Sholademi	Economic and financial crimes commission (EFCC)
16. Janet Elor	Nigeria Security and civil Defence Corps (NSCDC)
17. Hadiza ina Aminu	Nigeria Correctional Service (NCoS)
18. Ben- Ezea Stella Sandra	National Bureau of statistics (NBS)
19. Saadatu Shetima	National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)
20. Lasisi babatunde	Nigeria Police Force (NPF)

Appendices

- NAPTIP VAPP Cases Filed in Court in 2021
- Survivors' Success Stories
- Inmate Population by Custodial Centres on Rape and Sexual Offences for 2021
- 2021 Events Photo Speak

NAPTIP VAPP CASES FILED IN COURT IN 2021

S/N	Suit Name	Charge Number/Offence
1	FRN V ALHAJI DANLADI SULE	CR/075/2020 Section 1(2) and Section 5 (1) Rape & Offensive Conduct File 11th March 2021.
2	FRN VS GBENGA ADISINA	CR/025/2021 Section 1(1) Rape File 27th January 2021.
3	FRN VS CHUKWUDI PETER	CR/233/21 Section 1(2) Rape File 12th July 2021
4	FRN V THONY OMOHA	CR/276/2021 Section 1 & 5(1) Rape & Offensive Conduct File 4th August 2021
5	FRN VS ABUBAKAR MUSTAPHA DANREK	CR/296/2021 Section 1(2) Rape File 10th August 2021
6	FRN VS JULIUS OGAR	Section 1(1) Rape File 1st September 2021
7	FRN VS SANI YUSUF	Section 1(1) Rape File 1st September 2021
8	FRN VS CHIZOBA NNAEMEKA	CR/473/2021 Section 1(2) & Section 25 (a) Rape & Incest Filed 6th October 2021
9	FRN VS JANET GOODWIL	CR/475/2021 Section 2 (1) Inflicting injury Filed 6th October 2021
10	FRN VS AHMED BALA	CR/476/2021 Section 2(1) Filed 6th October 2021
11	FRN VS CHIOLA GALAPLIOVE O	CR/474/2021 Section 4(c) Willfully placing a person in fear of physical injury Filed 6th October 2021

S/N	Suit Name	Charge Number/Offence
12	FRN VS CHIOLA OKECHUKWU	CR/542/2021 Section 2 (1) Inflicting physical Injury
13	FRN VS BENNETT ESSIEN	CR/544/2021 Section 1(2) & Section 25 Rape
14	FRN VS ARSEER FRANCIS	CR/051/2022 Section 1(1) & Section 2, Section 5 Rape & Offensive Conduct
15	FRN V OMOTUNDE SAMSON	CR/613/2021 Section 1(1) & Section 5 Rape & Offensive Conduct Filed 18th November 2021
16	FRN V NKIRUKA EMEKA IGWE	CR/008/2022 Section 2 (1) Inflicting Injury
17	FRN V ANN DANIEL	CR/054/2022 Section 2 (1) & 14 (2) Inflicting of Injury & Emotional Verbal and Psychological abuse
18	FRN VS IZUCHUKWU MOGHALU	CR/099/2022 Section 9 (1) Forceful ejection from house
19	FRN VS UYOATA WALTER ESSIEN	CR/232/2021 Section 14 (1) Emotional, verbal & psychological abuse Filed 12th July 2021
20	FRN VS CHIKA ADIONYE	CR/274/2021 Section 5(1) & Section 1(1) Rape Filed 4th August 2021
21	FRN Vs Patrick Otasuwe Osawaru	CR/225/20221 Section 14 (1) & 4 (1), 9(1) VAPPA Filed 8th July, 2021
22	FRN Vs Hilda Iloba	CR/055/2021 Section 2(1) and 14 (1) VAPPA 1st March 2021

Survivors' Success Stories⁴

#1.

Ms Z is a victim of rape. She was referred to WOTCLEF and is currently receiving educational empowerment at a government secondary school in the FCT.

#2.

Ms V is a victim of sexual abuse and violence against persons, whose case has been charged to court. Pending litigation, she has been referred to WOTCLEF for Educational empowerment.

#3.

Ms B is a victim of Incest by her biological father, whom she testified against at a high court in FCT. Ms B was referred to Media Campaign against Human Trafficking (MeCAHT) for educational empowerment under NAPTIP Sponsorship. She started from JSS 3 and she has just written her SSCE. She will proceed to university afterwards.

#4.

Ms A is a 13-year-old victim of sexual abuse by her guardian. The victim was referred to a private boarding school in Nasarawa State for educational empowerment and she has successfully completed Jss1. she is currently in JSS2. Her case is still in court.

#5.

Ms T is a victim of physical abuse by her guardian. The 14-year-old victim was referred to MeCAHT for her educational empowerment. She is currently enrolled in a private school in the FCT.

⁴ Pseudonyms are used to protect the identity and privacy of victims. NAPTIP obtained the informed consent and assent to the inclusion of their stories in this report.

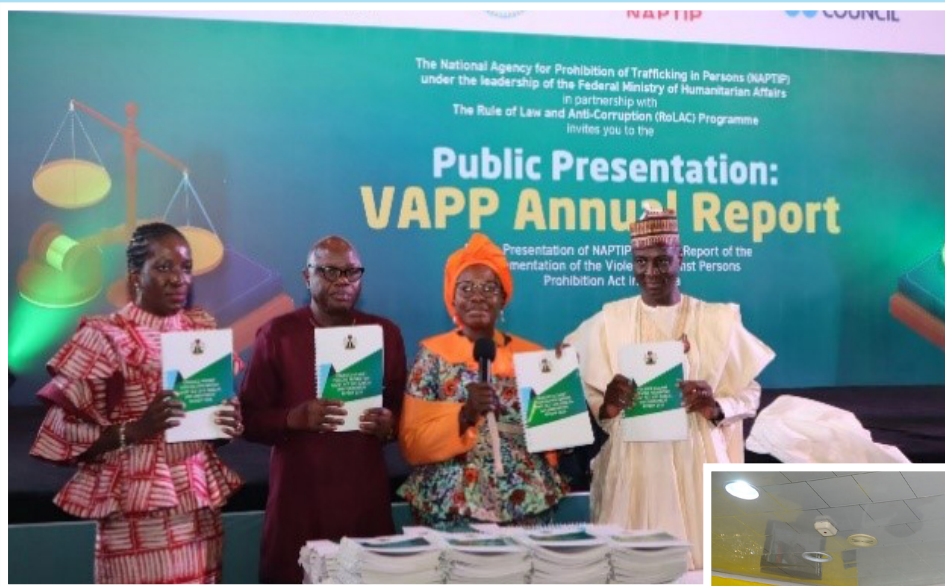
NIGERIA CORRECTIONAL SERVICE											
INMATES POPULATION BY CUSTODIAL CENTRES ON RAPE AND SEXUAL OFFENCES FOR 2021											
S/N	STATE	CUSTODIAL CENTRES	CONVICTED			AWAITING TRIAL PERSONS			SUM TOTAL		
			Male	Female	TOTAL	Male	Female	Total	Male (Total)	Female (Total)	Grand TOTAL
1	ABIA	Aba	13		13	17		17	30		30
		TOTAL	13		13	17		17	30		30
2	ABUJA (FCT)	Suleja	9		9	18		18	27		27
		Kuje				43		43	43		43
		Dukpa Farm	1		1				1		1
		TOTAL	10		10	61		61	71		71
3	ADAMAWA	Yola old				46		46	46		46
		Yola new	1		1	14		14	15		15
		Jimeta				16		16	16		16
		TOTAL	1		1	76		76	77		77
5	ANAMBRA	Awka	1		1	13		13	14		14
		Onitsha	1		1	38		38	39		39
		Nnewi	4		4	20		20	24		24
		Aguata	2		2	14		14	16		16
		TOTAL	8		8	85		85	93		93
8	BENUE	Gboko	3		3	7		7	10		10
		MSCC Makurdi				14		14	14		14
		TOTAL	3		3	21		21	24		24
9	BORNO	New Maiduguri	84		84	40		40	124		124
		Max. Sec Maidu.	7		7				7		7
		TOTAL	91		91	40		40	131		131
10	CROSS-RIVER	Calabar	11		11	34		34	45		45
		TOTAL	11		11	34		34	45		45
12	EBONYI	Abakaliki	10		10	31		31	41		41
		Afikpo	2		2	6		6	8		8
		TOTAL	12		12	37		37	49		49
13	EDO	Benin (old)***	4		4	6		6	10		10
		Benin (oko)N	11		11	51		51	62		62
		Auchi	15		15	23		23	38		38
		Ubiaja	4		4	2		2	6		6
		TOTAL	34		34	82		82	116		116

14	EKITI	Ado- Ekiti	15		15	56		56	71		71
		TOTAL	15		15	56		56	71		71
19	KADUNA	Kaduna	8		8	377		377	385		385
		Zaria				14		14	14		14
		Saminaka sat				1		1	1		1
		Soba sat				1		1	1		1
		TOTAL	8		8	393		393	401		401
22	KEBBI	Old Kebbi	4		4	29		29	33		33
27	NIGER	MSCC Kontagora				3		3	3		3
		Minna Old	4		4	11		11	15		15
		New-Bussa	4		4	1		1	5		5
		Kagara	6		6				6		6
		TOTAL	14		14	15		15	29		29
28	OGUN	Abeokuta	20		20	34		34	54		54
		Ijebu-Ode	8		8	18		18	26		26
		Ilaro	10		10	28		28	38		38
		Shagamu	3		3	11		11	14		14
		New MSCC Abeok	12		12	58		58	70		70
		TOTAL	53		53	149		149	202		202
29	ONDO	Okitipupa				1		1	1		1
		MSCC- Ondo	4		4	11		11	15		15
		Owo	2		2	21		21	23		23
		MSCC Akure	20		20				20		20
		TOTAL	26		26	33		33	59		59
30	OSUN	Ile-Ife	18		18	12		12	30		30
		TOTAL	18		18	12		12	30		30
33	RIVERS	Ahaoda				38		38	38		38
		Degema				29		29	29		29
		Port-Harcourt				93		93	93		93
		TOTAL				160		160	160		160
35	TARABA	Jalingo	4		4	38		38	42		42
		TOTAL	4		4	38		38	42		42
36	YOBE	Gashua	7		7	3		3	10		10
		Nguru	5		5				5		5
		MSCC Potiskum	16		16	33		33	49		49
		TOTAL	28		28	36		36	64		64
			693	0	693	2731	0	2731	3424	0	3424

2021

EVENTS PHOTO SPEAK







Violence Against Persons
(Prohibition) **Act 2015**

Annual Report

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